

lish marriage customs had undergone an important change?

As to the differences between the laws of Deuteronomy and Exodus, the explanation cannot be better given than in Professor Smith's own words: "The case contemplated is not that of seduction, but of violence to a maiden." In law, different premises habitually lead to different conclusions.

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A smaller divergence between the modes of effecting the contract for family bondage may be now made clear. The Judgement-book, Exodus xxi. 6, ordains that the master shall bring his slave "to God"; there at the door of the sanctuary, the centre of the administration of justice, the master shall bore his ear through with an awl, affixing it momentarily to the door-post, so that under the authority of religion he becomes a slave "for ever." The corresponding law in Deuteronomy xv. 12-18, introduces some interesting modifications. It is extended to women; it lays emphatic stress on generous recognition of the six years' forced labour; and in conclusion it retains the symbolic action with the awl. But it omits all reference to "God." The door-post to which the slave is attached is that of the householder's own dwelling. The public and official ceremony is converted into a private and domestic incident. The meaning of this change is not obscure. The law of Exodus belongs to the code which admits a plurality of sanctuaries: the Deuteronomic principles recognise but one. Important ceremonies, like the annual festivals, are transferred to the only centre of worship. There, too, must tithes be consumed (xiv. 23 . .), an express provision being inserted for those who lived too far off to take their tithes thither in kind. The case of the household slave, however, was not important enough to require the intervention of the supreme authorities in the capital, and the reference to justice and religion dropped ["The Hexateuch," I. 55-56; cf. Driver, Deuteronomy 184].

Nobody would infer from this that the translation "God," on which practically the whole of the above rests, is only an admittedly doubtful rendering of אֱלֹהִים, a word which is by some translated "judges."